

Email & Communication Policy

Policy No: POL-IT-006 | Version: v1.3 | Department: IT & HR Department | Effective: March 17, 2026

1. PURPOSE

This policy governs the use of company email, messaging platforms, and other communication tools. It ensures professional, secure, and appropriate use of all communication channels provided by the organization.

2. SCOPE

This policy applies to all employees using company-provided email accounts, collaboration tools (Microsoft Teams, Slack), and any other company communication platforms.

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4. EMAIL USAGE GUIDELINES

4.1 Business Use

Company email is provided primarily for business communication. Limited personal use is tolerated but must not interfere with professional duties or violate this policy.

4.2 Prohibited Email Activities

- Sending spam, chain letters, or mass unsolicited emails.
- Forwarding company emails to personal email accounts.
- Using company email to subscribe to non-work-related mailing lists.
- Sending emails that contain harassing, discriminatory, or offensive content.
- Impersonating colleagues, management, or external parties.

- Auto-forwarding work emails to external addresses.

5. PROFESSIONAL STANDARDS

5.1 Email Etiquette

- Use a professional greeting and sign-off in all external emails.
- Include a proper email signature with name, title, and contact information.
- Respond to internal emails within 4 business hours; external emails within 1 business day.
- Use CC and BCC appropriately — do not CC unnecessarily.
- Verify recipient addresses carefully before sending sensitive information.

5.2 Subject Lines

Use clear, concise subject lines that accurately describe the email content. Add [CONFIDENTIAL] prefix when emailing sensitive business information.

6. ANTI-PHISHING AWARENESS

Phishing is one of the most common cyberattack vectors. All employees must be able to identify and respond to phishing attempts.

6.1 Identifying Phishing Emails

- Unexpected requests for login credentials, financial information, or personal data.
- Urgent language demanding immediate action (account suspended, payment overdue).
- Mismatched sender address (display name vs. actual email domain).
- Suspicious attachments or links — hover over links to verify the URL destination.
- Poor grammar, spelling errors, or unusual formatting.

6.2 What To Do

- Do NOT click links or download attachments from suspicious emails.
- Report phishing emails to security@company.com and mark as phishing in your email client.
- Do not reply to, forward, or engage with the suspicious email.

Note: The IT Security team conducts simulated phishing tests quarterly. Employees who fail are required to complete additional training.

7. COLLABORATION TOOLS

Approved collaboration tools include Microsoft Teams, Zoom (Enterprise), and Confluence. Use of unapproved tools (WhatsApp, Telegram, personal Slack) for company business is prohibited.

- Do not share confidential files via personal cloud storage in team channels.
- Video conference links must not be shared publicly or on social media.
- Meeting recordings require consent of all participants before recording.
- Channel names and content must remain professional and work-appropriate.

8. CONFIDENTIAL COMMUNICATIONS

- Confidential information must only be shared over encrypted channels.
- Use [CONFIDENTIAL] tag in subject lines for sensitive emails.
- Large confidential file transfers must use the company-approved secure file transfer portal.
- Do not discuss confidential matters in public places where you may be overheard.
- Encrypted email (S/MIME or PGP) must be used for highly sensitive external communications.

9. RETENTION & ARCHIVING

- All company emails are automatically archived for a minimum of 3 years.
- Employees must not delete emails related to active legal matters or investigations.
- Email archives are subject to legal discovery processes.
- Mailbox storage limits apply — employees must regularly archive or delete non-essential emails.

Note: Company email accounts are company property. Upon termination, accounts are deactivated within 24 hours and retained for 90 days before deletion.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

EMPLOYEE ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I, the undersigned, confirm that I have read, understood, and agree to comply with this policy. I understand that violation of this policy may result in disciplinary action.

Employee Name:	_____	Date:	_____
Employee ID:	_____	Signature:	_____
Department :	_____	Manager:	_____

For questions regarding this policy, contact the IT Department at it-policy@company.com